

Publication: Collaborative Care for Women Veterans: A Randomized Trial

Authors

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Abstract

This study evaluated the effectiveness of a tailored collaborative care intervention for depression among women Veterans.

Methods

****Participants:**** We enrolled 300 women Veterans with major depression from 5 VA medical centers. Participants were required to have a PHQ-9 score ≥ 10 and be receiving care at the VA.

****Intervention:**** A care manager-delivered intervention using motivational interviewing and problem-solving therapy, with psychiatry consultation. Sessions were delivered over 12 weeks.

****Primary Outcome:**** Depression remission defined as PHQ-9 < 5 at 6 months.

****Secondary Outcomes:****

****Analysis:**** Mixed-effects logistic regression with random intercepts for site, adjusting for baseline PHQ-9, age, race, and marital status. We used Bonferroni correction for multiple comparisons across secondary outcomes.

Results

At 6 months, 42% of intervention participants achieved remission compared to 28% in usual care (OR=1.87, 95% CI [1.12, 3.12], $p=0.02$). The intervention group showed greater improvement in SF-12 mental component scores (mean difference = 4.3, $p=0.01$). No significant differences were found for quality of life or treatment engagement.

Conclusions

Collaborative care significantly improved depression remission and functional status among women Veterans, supporting the implementation of gender-tailored approaches in VA settings.